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r/GooglePixel • 1y ago

buiiban12



Frustrated and sick of Google's practises

Filtered - Rule #9

I've got a pixel 6 right before the launch of pixel 7, and I loved it. A lot of features were not available for me, such as screen calling, due to living in Romania and Google not selling it officially here. I was fine with that because the phone was really good and it wasn't much of an inconvenient. At the launch of the Pixel 9 pro XL I saw all the nice features that it had, with the Pixel Studio, Gemini advanced, Add me and most importantly the Pixel screenshots.

I wanted to buy this phone solely for the screenshots app because I have ADHD and I forget almost everything. I pre-ordered this phone on the 14th of August to get a better deal with the storage, and also a 200 euro discount for a buyback offer.

After the phone arrived, it looked and felt awesome and premium, but when I started it and checked it, my heart sank in a sea of disappointment. The Pixel Studio and screenshots were not even installed on the phone, thinking it was from Android 14, I've opted in for Android 15 beta. There was the same issue. I've downloaded the APK from the internet, installed the app and the AI is not doing anything. The screenshots are not being processed (only manually if I go to each screenshot and press the button) and if I search anything on there for 80% is not finding anything.

Another issue was regarding Gemini advanced. I couldn't get the offer, asked the Google customer support about it and after wasting an hour and a half of back-and-forward messages I was told to wait. In the end I finally got Gemini advance working, but Gemini is not good at all and cannot talk in Romanian. Though chat gpt is working perfectly in romanian.

When I tried to plug a USB hub into the phone I also encountered issues. The desktop mode is not working, I cannot do anything on it, it's just showing the image on the screen but can't control it. I've tried to plug in a mouse and keyboard but only the keyboard is working, not the mouse.

There are a lot more issues with this phone than I could imagine. I understand that it was just released, but I don't think there are many other phone manufacturers that releases a phone this bad.

And why on earth is google discriminating Romania and other countries from EU so bad that we cannot have most of the good features that this phone can offer? I paid the same money as the guys from US and UK, but cannot use pixel studio and screenshots?

I think I'll return this phone in the next week because it's not worth it. At least Samsung and Apple are offering all their features to everybody.

End of rant



Archived post. New comments cannot be posted and votes cannot be cast.

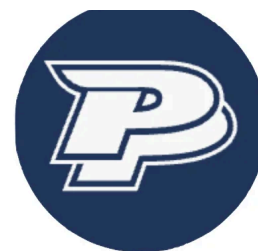
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Yeah it pretty much says this everywhere related to the app:

Important: Pixel Studio is currently only available on the Pixel 9 series in English in the United States, United Kingdom, Canada, Australia, India, Ireland, Singapore and Malaysia.

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

Many limitations due to the privacy laws and GDPR (I am in the NL) and Google's privacy practices. Of course, some of them could be market related rather than privacy limitations. And Google is making more money with add-on features. So, in combination with these I would say.

I have a Pixel 7 and was pre-ordered the Pixel 9 Pro. After the delay over the delay, I cancelled it. But still, I am very much tempted to get it even though certain functions may not be available.

**LCFCgamer** • 1y ago

Pixel 8 Pro

Google products in UK & EU:

Pay more than US, often far, far more. Get less, sometimes much, much less.

**AndrewFrozen30** • 1y ago

Note that it isn't Google's fault, I know Romania doesn't get much features, and sometimes we are getting used to that (I am Romanian myself)

But the EU doesn't allow for such things, so it's not only not available in Romania, it's not available anywhere in the EU.

**Pristine-Notice3888** • 1y ago

But that is in huge part what corporate propaganda wants you to believe. Most features could be built up to be in compliance with EU law.

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regulators to loosen those rules because the population gets angry.



AndrewFrozen30 • 1y ago

And you expect Google to do it?

Obviously not, like yeah, if they did properly follow the rules EU forces, they COULD do it. But let's not have much hope there.



Pristine-Notice3888 • 1y ago

Time will tell but most likely not in the near future. Currently the battle between the EU and US corporations is hot. Apple for example is still mad about USB-C which has been forced upon them by the EU.



AndrewFrozen30 • 1y ago

As it should be honestly Fuck Apple and their monopoly.

I'm sure they are pissed about the Epic Games Launcher thing too.



Brocolium • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

Nah. Most of the missed featured are because they are geared for english language. Non-EU countries also misses on a lot of them. It's too easy to blame the EU for everything



AndrewFrozen30 • 1y ago

Yes, I am aware. And I just said that.

But in this case, AI is the reason. EU is more restrictive to AI than the USA is.

As it should be honestly. AI is still in the "development" phase.

Although it can be frustrating to buy something for the features it promotes. To only not get them in the end is annoying. And Google is at fault for promoting this as a "world-wide" thing.

The reason they are not available is simple, it's EU's fault.

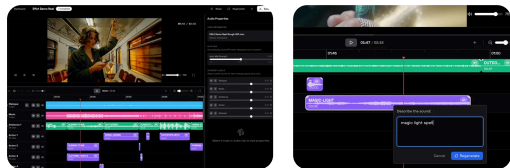


isjahammer • 1y ago

Also they should have mentioned that in the presentation. Or maybe adjusted the price a bit for the missing features.

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Automatic sound design that brings your video to life. Sound effects, ambience, and mix — done for you.

effect.io[Sign Up](#)**Brocolium** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

In France if you turn the system language to US English you can use pixel Studio and the screenshot app. But it's unfortunate that we don't have that stock and still need to install it with an apk

**catchawabbit** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

How do you get it? My phone is in English and I live in Germany u didn't get those apps, but oddly enough I have Gemini live.

**ctrl-brk** • 1y ago

Pixel 8



Top 1% Commenter

Your flair says P8 but I assume you now have a P9? I sideloaded the APK on my P8 and it failed at downloading the models.

**Brocolium** • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

Yes it works only on the 9 series even when sideloading. At least for now

**TheOnlyRealColonel** • 1y ago

Pixel 9

I live in NL so I'm also missing a lot of these features which sucks a lot, but in the end it sounds like you blindly bought it without doing research. I bought the pixel 9 as well but was aware of what I wouldn't get. Like the screenshots and studio app. Which by the way you can just download from APK mirror and they work flawlessly.

**buiban12** **OP** • 1y ago

I wrote in my post that I did it and still not working as intended

**Gumledk** • 1y ago

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Pixel 7a

Sorry to say this has little to do with Google. But I'm sure if Google forced themselves to release everything everywhere at the same time they could do it. They are huge and have power, despite regulations.

I hate everything in Spanish and Europe comes always late from half a year to even 3 years like live captions in Spanish.

**Alone-Duty7777** • 1y ago

I'm not bothered by all the AI shenanigans but all I wanted was call screen on my P6 🙄. Like another poster said, we're just subsidising US users.

**[deleted]** • 1y ago

If you want a consistent stable experience, buy an iPhone. If you want everything constantly in flux, a state of beta, features working at a coin flip, get a Pixel.

**ChickenFlavoredCake** • 1y ago

What you described sounds very on brand for Google. It also sounds like Apple products might be better for you.

Apple products pretty much work as advertised. There's no technical knowledge or jumping through any hoops required to get something working properly. I have a Macbook Air and iPad Pro and they both work flawlessly. They integrate well together too. Apple does a great job of hiding the tech behind the screen leaving a simple, intuitive UI for you to get things done.

Google on the other hand, everything they offer come with an asterisk. Almost nothing is intuitive or simple. In general you need to be a tech person to be able to get something working. Even then, it won't fully work because of some obscure bug they'll never fix, or for some stupid oversight that will take a while to fix.

Google has great ideas but the implementation is often very poorly thought out and executed. I'm sort of trapped in the Google ecosystem on the phone side so I don't want to switch away from Android / Pixel.

If you want desktop mode then Samsung Galaxy Ultra phones might be better.

**buiban12** OP • 1y ago

I am a tech person, had a PC for the past 18 years, worked in IT for the past 8 years or so, I do know how to fix my tech issues, but those server sides limitations are beyond me.

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Thank you for your input, I really appreciate it.



ChickenFlavoredCake • 1y ago

I do know how to fix my tech issues, but those server sides limitations are beyond me.

You know, I wouldn't be surprised if some of those issues are in fact local issues caused by some random Google fuckups.

I too downloaded the screenshots apk from apkmirror on my P7P. AI doesn't process the screenshots either. I just thought it's because it's P7P.

I don't know when was the last time you used apple products or why you hate them, but I think they're worth a try nowadays. I've been a PC user for 30 years and my PC desktop is still my main device. I build a new one every few years. Windows degrades to shit pretty quickly but my Macbook Air M2 is still as sleek as day 1.



buiban12 OP • 1y ago

I don't like the ecosystem from Apple, the price of the products what they offer (but google went on their route with this pixel 9 phones so yeah..) and the lack of customisation. Windows PC is also my main device, that's why I want a phone that can connect to it so I can use it even when I'm not at home.



nhojb • 1y ago

Apple products pretty much work as advertised.

That may have been true in the past, but will not be for the new Apple Intelligence features. In the iOS 18.1 beta AI features are only available in US English (Google it). I expect that even after the public release later this year (or next?) there will be a slow rollout. It's nothing to do with Google or Apple artificially restricting features, it's just that they are being very cautious with AI. Understandably so.

There's also the added complication of the EU Digital Markets Act, which is leading to regional differences in features.



Xenofastiq • 1y ago

Pixel 9 Pro

Apple products work pretty much as advertised. Until all this Apple Intelligence stuff starts being advertised a LOT more, and people start realizing that they are ALSO only really limiting it to just US English. Not to mention, just fully excluded from users in the EU and in China. AI is slowly turning Apple into these other companies too

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[chatomo.ai](#)[Sign Up](#)**SonicSarge** • 1y ago

Try setting system language to English

**buiban12** **OP** • 1y ago

I never set it to Romanian or any language other than English US. If I want to find a setting or anything else in Romanian it will take me 2-5 business days. With it set to English the features are still unavailable.

Also tried to market unlock it, but could not install the apk, receiving the error that device is not supported for this app

**SonicSarge** • 1y ago

Ok. Well that's the reason I wont buy another Pixel. Google doesn't care about any country outside of the USA. Next time I'm buying Samsung again

**kabammi** • 1y ago

Yeah I've got a pixel 6 pro. I've used chatgpt+ for a while. I tried Gemini and it's not comparable. I'm waiting to see what happens from here before buying another pixel. I feel like it's almost Day 0 now of a new dawn and the pixel 9 is a v1 of a new era. OpenAI may be considering a new device, or a skin, and if like to see that launch first and Google's response to it first.

**Cosminacho** • 1y ago

Same situation here. I felt in this trap with P8P. honestly, the AI features are super overated. I've barely used them.

I'll my P8P as a work phone and I'll just buy a smart dumbphone next. Just to get rid of distractions.

It's shitty that google pulls this kind of stuff. I really wanted the service that answers the phone for you :)



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